

9.7

The negotiating process

Worksheet

- A** Describe a recent negotiation.
- Who was involved?
 - What did you negotiate about?
 - Was the outcome as you expected? If not, can you explain why?
- B** Describe a past situation where you feel you were effective as a negotiator. What exactly were you doing that made you effective?
- Describe a past situation where you feel you were *not* effective as a negotiator. Can you identify why you were not effective?
- C** Describe a recent negotiation where you faced a difficult person or situation. How did you deal with things? If you could have the same negotiation again, what would you do differently?
- D** ‘Time and location are crucial factors in a negotiation’. Do you agree? Can you give an example of where you suffered because you had no control over these factors?
- E** Some people think of negotiating as a constructive dialogue leading to a ‘win-win’ outcome. Others think it is basically a battle based on power and tactics.
- What is your approach to negotiating?
 - Can you give examples where you have used different approaches?
- F** Discuss a negotiation that you are going to have in the near future. Make some notes first.
- **Your objectives.** What exactly do you want from the negotiation?
 - **Your power.** What power do you have?
 - **Their power.** What power does the other side have?

Negotiating theory suggests that there are five basic ways to change the balance of power:

- 1 the promise of reward
- 2 the threat of punishment
- 3 the introduction of new factual evidence
- 4 the deliberate introduction of distracters such as time deadlines or the intervention of a new person
- 5 changes in confidence levels

- **Balance of power.** Can you change this?
- **Ideal outcome.** What would be the best possible result? Consider each main issue.
- **Realistic outcome.** Consider this in detail for each issue.
- **Bottom line.** What is the minimum you would accept on each issue?

